



Semester 2 Finals Review Guide

History S+ Review Guide

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Range: Causes of WWII - Cold War

Note: Review Guide are UNOFFICIAL sources of reference and do NOT include or hint at questions in the actual exam!

Causes of WW2 (1939-1945)

1) Unresolved problems from the Treaty of Versailles

- Germany and its allies were held responsible for all destruction and costs from the Treaty of Versailles where they lost territory, were forced to pay huge reparations, take responsibility for WW1 through the war guilt clause, and forced to demilitarize their nation
-  this resulted in Germany suffering from inflation and unemployment due to their inability to pay the reparations
- Germany felt bitter and desperate, they wanted freedom and territory back
- resulted in a strong ambition for Germany to make a comeback in WW2

2) Great Depression and (which led to) the Rise of Dictatorships

- The American Wall Street Crash of October 1929 made the world suffer from 'Great Depression' where a chain reaction occurred: Due to America's need to pay for their own debts, Germany couldn't seek financial support to pay their reparations anymore, and France and Britain hence wouldn't make their loan payments to Germany anymore
- While the current governments were unable to revive their countries, totalitarian leaders arose
- Totalitarianism refers to a system of government in which one party tries to rule with complete control over every aspect of the lives of its citizen
- Totalitarian leaders: Joseph Stalin of USSR (communist), Adolf Hitler of Germany (fascism), Benito Mussolini of Italy (fascism), Emperor Hirohito of Japan (constitutional monarch)
- Though these leaders had different ideologies, **they all thrive towards MILITARISM + NATIONALISM** which are key factors that led them to aggressively demand control over other nations

3) Failure of the League of Nations

- The League of Nations was an international forum and an international collective security arrangement where nations that joined agreed to settle disputes rather than engage in war
Why it's considered 'failure':
- Since the US, as a major power, refused to join the League of Nations, countries grew suspicious
- 1931, when Japan invaded Manchuria (northeastern of china), the League did not stop the Japanese
- 1935, Italy invaded Abyssinia (current day Ethiopia) but instead of helping, Britain and France signed a secret pact to give Abyssinia to Italy
- Meanwhile these invasions, Germany also left the League and rearmed itself; league called for a disarmament conference but Germany ignored it, it instead stated to regain territories like Rhineland
- Conclusion: the League of Nations resulted in severe distrust between nations; small nations were neglected and lots of countries disobeyed its rules

4) Appeasement (1935-1939)

- Britain and France determined that engaging in conflict with Germany will result in a devastating war like WWI
- done mainly by **British Prime Minister Neville Chamberlain**
- Main reasons: Britain wasn't prepared for war, some felt sympathetic for Hitler and his complaints
- appeasements included granting Hitler land, control over nations, and the freedom to remilitarize
- greatest example for appeasement: Munich Agreement
- **Stakes of appeasement: Britain and France willingly gave Germany Sudetenland (western Czechoslovakia which had German-speaking people) as long as Hitler promised to not go further**
- German citizens found this reasonable because Hitler claimed that he wanted to unite all German speaking people into the Third Reich (Nazi Germany)
- **Anschluss** was also created, dedicated to Germany's future expansion; it's a union between Austria and Germany in 1938 because Austria provided strategic land, resources, and soldiers that were adequate for Germany exploitation



- Though Chamberlain felt confidence that British will finally be in peace, **Winston Churchill (a British statesman) strongly opposed appeasement** since he knew that Hitler's footsteps would not stop there after annexing Sudetenland
- Conclusion: appeasement resulted in WW2 because Hitler developed unstoppable hubris, he became even more demanding - imperialism

!! 5) The invasion of Poland - OFFICIAL/DIRECT CAUSE FOR WW2 by Hitler

- Britain, France, Russia previously formed an alliance called the Allied powers
- August 1939, Russia left that alliance and instead joined Hitler; signing the **Nazi- Soviet Pact - a nonaggression pact that publicly stated that the rival nations would maintain peaceful relations**
- **they agreed to divide Poland into 'spheres of influence'** where Germany gets western Poland, USSR gets eastern Poland
- September 1st 1939, Germany invades Poland with the power of **blitzkrieg (lightning war - defeating opponents using a series of short military campaigns)**

which caused lots of immediate harm to Poland (how they won)

- German's Luftwaffe was a critical part of blitzkrieg
- September 17th 1939, USSR occupied Eastern Poland
- Poland's location was geographically vulnerable due to its location right between USSR and Germany
- Context about Hitler's invasion on Poland: he claimed that ethnic Germans living in Poland needed protection (excuse to invade Poland), Britain and France declared war on Hitler (they realized appeasement failed), Hitler had panzers (tanks) and well-trained army (secretly in the past years, violating the treaty of Versailles)

6) Other Causes (also causes of WW1)

- M.A.I.N - Militarism, Alliances, Imperialism, Nationalism
- Alliances:

1) Axis Powers: Germany, Italy, Japan

2) Allies Powers: U.S., Britain, France

- USSR - originally allied with Axis powers until Germany invaded USSR in 1941

The 2 Theaters of WW2 - Pacific and European



- 65 million estimated total worldwide deaths; 40 million are civilians

1) European Theater (significant statistics)

- 150 trillion ways for German 'enigma' machine to encode a single letter
- 400,000 tons of supplies delivered to the Allied Front in France
- 9.5 million estimated peak strength of the German armed forces during WW2
- 7600 women's army corps members serving in European theater by 1945 - portrays women's increasing authority

2) Pacific Theater (significant statistics)

- 3 atomic bombs dropped by the US during WW2

- 115,000 square miles of ocean covered in battles
- 20 million estimated deaths in China as a result of WW2 - china contributed to ww2 by resisting Japanese aggression, on the allies powers side

General Comparison:

1) Geography:

- European theater had dense continent, land-based
- Pacific theater had vast oceans, island chains, naval/marine-based, US-led

2) Technology in Military (based on 1)

- European theater: tanks, artillery, machine guns, code breaking (enigma from Germany), V2 rockets
- Pacific theater: aircraft carriers, nuclear bombs on Hiroshima and Nagasaki, submarines, planes

3) Deaths:

- European theater: 15-20 million military deaths, 30-35 million civilian deaths (more deadly)
- Pacific theater: 4 million military deaths, 10-12 million civilian deaths

U.S. Entry in WW2

Context

- Due to the 1)Great Depression which brought severe economic damage and political instability to the US as well as 2)the trauma from WW1; the US developed a mood of isolationism where the country want to intervene in anymore bloody conflicts
- Woodrow Wilson (previous president who wanted to join League of Nations but was blocked by congress) was replaced by Warren G. Harding who refuses (which aligns with what the citizens wanted) to join war, claiming the US needs to 'return to normalcy'

US still sinked in Isolationism

- **Neutrality Acts**: passed by US Congress which banned American citizens from trading with nations at war, loaning them money, or traveling on their ships
-  this was passed down after the failure of the League of Nations
- US believed that still no nation posed any direct threats

US getting indirectly involved

- 1932, President FDR (Franklin Delano Roosevelt) insisted on participating in WW2, but due to limitations set by neutrality acts, he decided to indirectly get involved in WW2 first
- 1939 November; American manufacturers were allowed to sell arms and supplies to nations at war - allowed British to buy American goods as long as paid up front and transported them in their own ships
- 1941 March; after Hitler conquered France and Britain was the 'one man standing', US passed the **Lend-Lease Act** which authorized US to lend war supplies to nations whose

defense he deemed 'vital to the defense of the US'; he said the best policy to keep US out of war was to become the **'Arsenal of Democracy'**

- 1941 August; Roosevelt and Churchill met on the Atlantic charter that talked about their desire to preserve peace and their commitment to working together later on for the war

__US getting directly involved

- **1941 December 7th; Japanese carrier planes attacked the American fleet at Pearl Harbor,** Hawaii which knocked out the pride of the US pacific fleet; one day later Congress declared war on Japan, Italy, and Germany declared war on the US

- **!!** US strategy: **'Germany first' strategy** (brought up by Churchill and Roosevelt) where they believed though the Japanese attacked, Germany was more threatening

War on the Eastern Front (Battle of Stalingrad/Operation Barbarossa)

Context

- **More combatants were killed on the Eastern Front than in all other theaters of WW2 combined**

- **!!** 1923, Hitler wrote **Mein Kampf** / "My Struggle" which said:

- Territorial expansion, racially pure state, destruction of Jews (laid ideological groundwork for the Holocaust)

- he believed in Germany's destiny to defeat a historic enemy - France, and pushing eastward into the USSR to exterminate communists and Slavs but he knew fighting both at once wasn't feasible (led to next bullet point)

- 1939 August, **Hitler signed Nazi-Soviet Pact - divide Poland, Baltic States (Latvia, Lithuania, Estonia), Romania, Finland into German and Soviet spheres of influence;** Germany gets west Poland, USSR gets east (strategically befriending USSR)

- Hitler's Purpose: avoid conflict with USSR when seizing Poland and France; he said "the sooner Russia is smashed the better"

- Hitler's wanted gains from winning this battle: exterminate Slavs, exterminate communism, gain access to valuable resources

- 1939 September; Germany and USSR both invade Poland

The War

- **!!** **1941 June 22; Operation Barbarossa: 3 million man invasion by Hitler of USSR (Hitler was hubristic, he believed USSR would be easy to defeat because its generals were inept and some political instability democratically since some opposed Stalin's regime)**

- Successful in early stages but later the Red Army (led by Bolsheviks/communists) made a major comeback (Red Army was the largest in the world with vast natural resources) and won

- US and UK united with USSR since they had a common enemy - Nazi Germany; so they together fought in the battle of Stalingrad

- Atrocities including beheadings and mass rapes occurred on a daily basis
- millions of captured soldiers died of exposure and maltreatment - inhumane conditions
- **Hitler lost majorly due to overwhelming determination - refused to retreat despite substantial casualties**

- 📌 Late 1942: German General Blumentritt after visiting eastern front said: "there was little timber available for constructing defenses, there were no proper trenches or fixed positions" so he suggested a step back but Hitler neglected it
- 1942-1943: soldiers say "I would eat a cat", "this isn't hell, this is ten times worse than hell"
- due to an arctic winter, Germans stopped with imperialism before Moscow
- 1942 July 28: STRONG NATIONALISM AND DEDICATION on both sides: Hitler wanted to wipe out males and deport females; Russian General Chuikov says "we will defend the city or die"
- Deaths: Axis powers: 850,000; Soviets: 750,000

Statistics:	
Major German territorial losses in 1942	9
Major German territorial losses in 1943	37
Total German	200,000+ (EST)
Casualties	
Total Soviet Casualties	1,000,000+ (EST)

- 🌟 Significance of the Battle of Stalingrad: marked Hitler's first major defeat and a shift in alliance where the USSR joins the allies powers

Wars in the European Theater (1941-1945)

- 1) Mid 1942: Allies agreed on a **'German First' Strategy**
 - allies all reached consensus on the fact that Japan was much of a smaller threat compared to Germany
- 2) November 1942: **Operation Torch - The invasion of North Africa**
 - Why? Original plan was for Generals George Marshall and Dwight Eisenhower to invade German occupied France directly in order to distract German troops from fighting the USSR by opening up a second front; but this wasn't feasible due to the lack of mobilization of the US army
 - This was Eisenhower's first combat assignment
 - Allies landed in Morocco and Algeria, then moved toward Tunisia (east) but they suffered some setbacks at Kasserine Pass (Feb 1943) but in 2 months they trapped numerous axis troops - they won

3) January 1943 (near the end of Operation Torch): **Casablanca Conference (held in Casablanca which is northwest of Morocco)** - where Roosevelt and Churchill met to decide future military plans

- outcomes: pursue the unconditional surrender of the axis powers, plan to invade Sicily first, then get to mainland Italy

4) July-September 1943: **Invasion of Sicily (Operation Husky) and Italy** .

- under Generals George Patton and Montgomery
- Sicily immediately surrendered but Hitler ordered to fight to the last man to keep Italy
- Later, the allies bombed Berlin (Nazi Production centers, nearly annihilating the **Luftwaffe**)
- the German Air Force, crucial for the success of D-DAY) Belgium and Northern France
- In the bombing of Berlin, the allies knew they were gonna face the most powerful air defense system in the world
- Dogfighting: a close combat between military aircraft

5) June 4 1944: Invasion of Italy

- **Kesselring (German military leader)** led this fight for Germany; driving the allied invasion force back into the sea at Salerno (southeast of Italy, aka. Toe of Italy)
- his key military strategy: he engaged the Gustav line: brilliant defensive entanglement of machine guns, booby traps, and mines stitched into Italy's mountains
- June 4, allies conquer Rome

6) June 6 1944: **D-DAY!!! - Invasion of Normandy (Operation Overlord)** .

- largest amphibious (land and water) war in WW2
- reason for success: allies invaded surprisingly - invaded Normandy instead of Calais where the channel was far narrower and axis defenses were stronger
- Under Eisenhower, allied forces **liberated Paris and Northern France and Belgium**
- **Liberation of Paris:**
- **august 25 1944, germany surrendered Paris to allies**
- opened up war on the western front - making Germany fight in both eastern and western front
- Allied advancements slowed down after liberating Paris because there were disagreements among them where they wanted to undergo different strategies (between indirect and direct; slowed down decision making and delayed offensives) Specifics of the War:
- Harsh conditions of this attack: the English Channel had rough seas and unpredictable weather and formidable beach obstacles
- pre-war; people said "we were getting ready for one of the biggest adventures of our lives"
- Midnight June 6, allies started attacking, they first sabotaged bridges and railroad lines to prevent defense from axis powers
- they then landed the largest amphibious force moving through the storm-tossed waters toward the beaches
- Americans were packed into flat-bottomed Higgins boats with vomit filling the bottom of the boats
- **Landing - 5 beaches: British and Canadians landed at Juno, Gold, Sword beaches; Americans landed at Omaha and Utah beaches**

- Omaha beach had the fiercest fighting due to steep cliffs; but Americans annihilated Omaha beach at a heavy cost with a loss rate over 13%
- Artillery Battalion says “if you thought about the possibilities of what lay ahead, it was more than your mind could take”

- Military Strategy: **Red Ball Express - an American truck convoy (groups) system which operated 24/7 with many African American drivers whom supplied sufficient fuel, ammunition, and other vital supplies to the American and allied forces advancing through France and Belgium after landing on Normandy**

- why the name? The system utilized designated routes marked with red balls and the trucks had labels of red balls for identification; so people could free up roads for coming troops

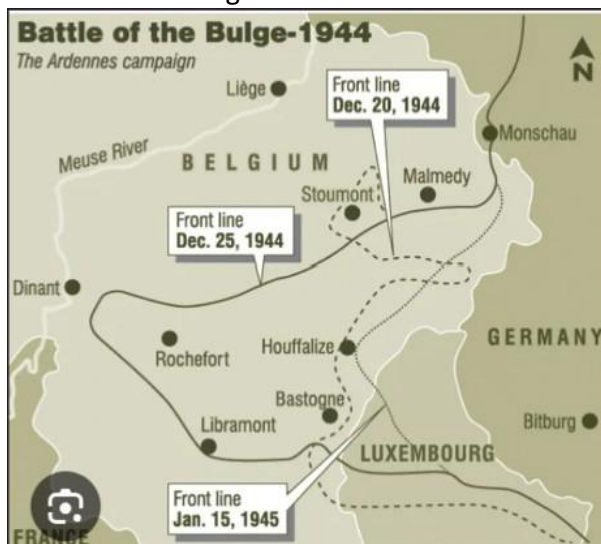
- 🌟 Significance: if D-Day had failed, attacks would not have been possible for another year, which would have given Hitler time to strengthen the Atlantic Wall, harass England with the newly developed v1 flying bombs and v2 rockets

2) September 1944: **Operation Market Garden - Failure**

- flawed plan to capture key bridges in the Netherlands and enter Germany quickly
- Allies attempted to break into the heart of Germany but fought losses with small gains
- ‘the wrong time, the wrong place’
- Germany had it all equipped
- allied losses: 12,00; over 250 aircrafts shot down

3) December 16 1944: **Battle of the Bulge**

- largest American infantry (land soldiers) war
- Hitler launched panzer units through the Ardennes Forest and pushed the allies far back that created a ‘bulge’ in the allies’ defensive line



- Allies comeback: skies cleared before Christmas so Allies’ strong aircrafts pounded the invading army (US was known for powerful air forces since it fought Japan in pacific theater)
- Allies pushed Germans back across the Rhine River
- this battle was a soldier’s fight without much direction from leaders
- Guts, self-respect, loyalty to comrades prevailed over ideology
- Allies won but; deaths: 19,000 American GI’s killed, 100,000 Germans died
- marked the OFFICIAL BEGINNING FOR THE FALL OF THE GERMAN EMPIRE

Wars in the Pacific Theater (1941-1944)

1) December 7th 1941: Japan attacks Pearl Harbor

- severely crippled the US pacific fleet
- US had to use aircraft carriers and submarines after its battleship fleet crippled in Hawaii
- Japan aimed to destroy US carrier fleet so that they could negotiate for peace

Between: Allied forces repeatedly bombed and stormed Japanese-held territory, targeting tiny islands as well as the jungles of New Guinea and the Philippines

- goal: secure airfields and supply bases that could serve as the launching points for future attacks



2) May 1942: Battle of the Coral Sea (Ended the peak of Japan)

- both sides suffered humongous loses
- definite win for the US
- marked the first defeat for Japan

3) June 1942: Battle of Midway

- TURNING POINT: US prevails, takes offensive for the first time
- marked first major US victory against Japan
- US destroyed four Japanese aircraft carriers

4) August 1942: Battle of Guadalcanal/Solomon Islands

- allies took the first vital step in driving the Japanese back in the pacific theater
- significance: the US stopped/prevented Japanese efforts from disrupting US supply routes to Australia and New Zealand
- William Douglas Lansford participated in this combat

5) March 1943: Island Hopping Strategy

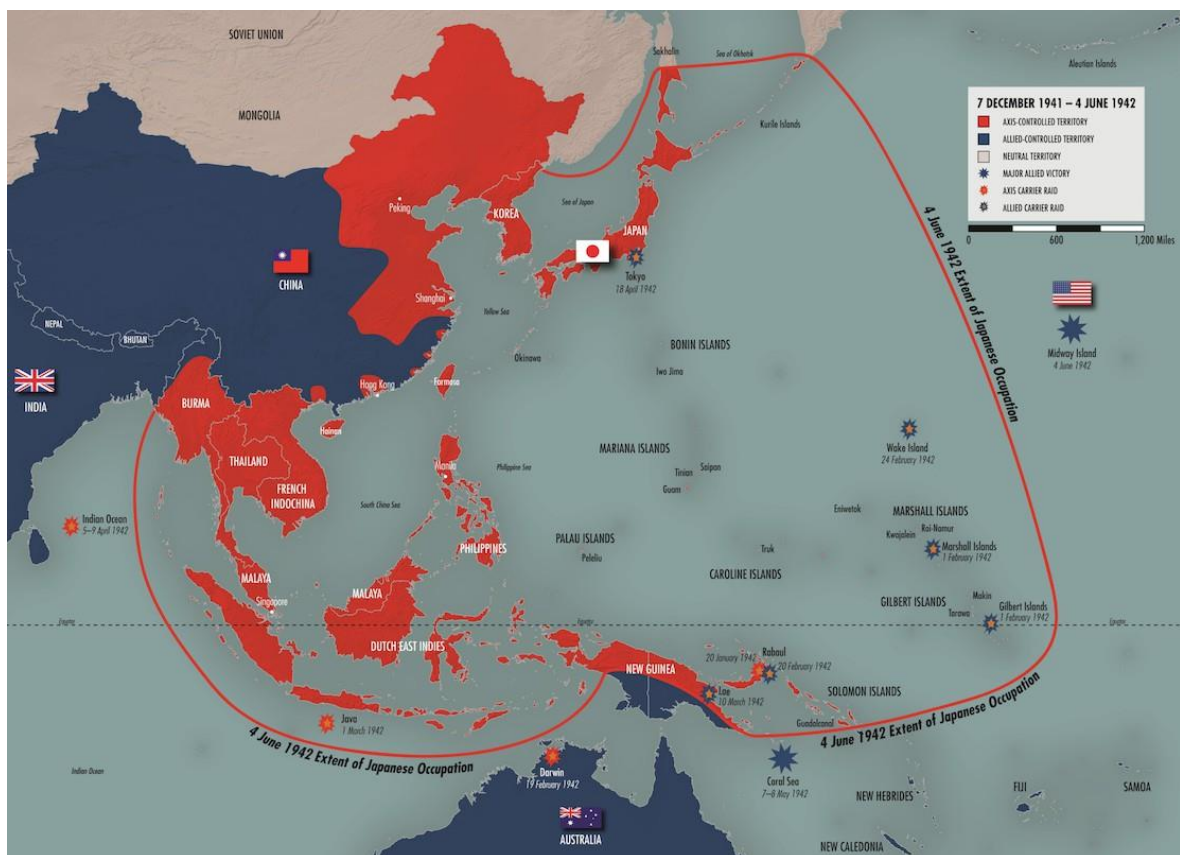
- definition: the practice of skipping over heavily fortified islands in order to seize lightly defended locations that could support the next advance
- turned the vast of pacific distances into an American ally, US used this to leapfrog across

the pacific

- practice: General Douglas MacArthur's (US commander) troops first captured New Guinea, but found the heavily defended island of Rabaul to be formidable, so the fleets pushed westwards to first invade the less-defended islands - they eventually captured Rabaul successfully
- why it worked out successfully: meanwhile MacArthur's troops practiced island hopping in the southwest pacific, there were central pacific campaigns in invading the Gilbert islands in November 1943; with two assaults on Japan, it crashed out

6) Jan/Feb 1944: Annihilating the Mariana Islands

- KEY FOR THE INVASION OF MAINLAND JAPAN
- Marianas were a particularly valuable asset since they were close enough to Japan for the US new B-29 bombs to bomb mainland Japan



7) Feb-April 1945: Battle of Iwo Jima and Okinawa

Battle of Iwo Jima

- why? It was a strategic air base located between the Mariana islands and Japan
- Japanese preparation: carved out underground fortifications that turned the volcanic island into a death trap for invading US marines
- the US planners only expected some brief campaigns but it happened to last over 5 weeks
- Japanese commander General Kuribayashi concentrated forces in northern Iwo Jima islands with made the battle very bloody
- names depicting the brutality of the combat: "The meat grinder" (850 US marines died) and "bloody gorge" (Japanese defenders made final stand)
- US eventually took over
- !! Symbol of Nationalism
- February 23 1945, when US troops reached Mount Suribachi, they raised a small American

flag but later returned to replace it with a larger flag - one of the most notable picture in WW2

- William Douglas Lansford also participated in this, part of the field -intelligence unit
- after this war, he worked as a Hollywood screenwriter and published books about history on WW2 and his experiences
- Howard N. McLaughlin participated in this battle as a member of the repair section (heavy equipment) but later due to lack of soldiers on the frontline he also joined, part of the army
- in his memoir, he wrote about the US marines' feelings toward the Japanese: "they neither liked or hated the Japs. They killed them without anger or mercy. To them they were part of the forces of evil that had to be destroyed"

Battle of Okinawa

- April 1 1945, US tenth army arrived in Okinawa (last invasion before mainland Japan)
- harsh conditions: heavy rains and rugged terrain
- US overcame northern Okinawa by April 18 easily but overcoming the south was DIFFICULT because Japanese anchored their defenses at Shuri Castle with a series of well-defended high ridges
- May 29 finally, US smashed down the Shuri Castle in southern Okinawa
- March 26; Kamikaze pilots: Japanese pilots intentionally crashed their planes into US aircraft carriers and other US battleships
- This victory caused 1200 American deaths including the Tenth army's commander Lieutenant General Simon Buckner
- Japanese: about 90,000 combatants died and 150,000 civilians died

The End of WW2 (1944-1945)

1. THE EUROPEAN THEATER (officially ended on May 2nd 1945)

Events that led to the end of war: (summary)

Allies: "the only solution to this war is Germany's unconditional surrender"

- 1) Operation Overlord (June 1944) and Battle of the Bulge (December 1944)
 - D-Day marked the beginning of Allied effort to liberate Western Europe from Hitler
 - After pushing eastward, allies fought battle of the bulge
- 2) USSR advancement from the east
 - After winning battle of Stalingrad and Kursk (southwest Russia) in 1943
 - 1945, USSR reached Poland and conquered Berlin
 - they liberated concentration camps like Auschwitz; allies soldiers find the camps spine-chilling
- 3) April 25th 1944, American and USSR troops converge on Elbe River near Torgau

- both knew the end of war was days away



Why Hitler lost so badly/Consequences:

- instead of surrendering when it was clear there was no turning back, he pulled grandfathers and children into the war
 - “fight to the last man”
 - German soldiers however, surrendered
 - when he finally realized his failure, he committed suicide
 - then German general signed contract with allies to express their unconditional surrender
-
- May 8 1945 - V-E day (victory in Europe day) where allies celebrated their victory

2. THE PACIFIC THEATER (officially ended on September 2)

- 🌟 May 1945: allies were still skeptical because Japan had never claimed their surrender so they might attack again



- August 6, US atomic bombed Hiroshima - killed 140,000 people
- USSR declares war on Japan and the Red Army takes Manchuria- Japan realizes an increase in enemy - led to their surrender
- August 9, US atomic bombed Nagasaki - killed 70,000 people
- August 14 Japanese then surrendered in the Potsdam conference
- August 14: VJ Day for Americans CELEBRATION ERUPTED ACROSS THE US
- September 2: official time for celebration (late because it's the day formal surrender documents were signed aboard the USS Missouri in Tokyo Bay): fireworks, confetti, parades on streets, NYC time square hung up American flags
- In Honolulu (capital of Hawaii), veterans and girlfriends crowded on trucks and drove around
- August 15: Britains VJ day; later than Americans because Americans wanted to join this one

- Brutality of WW2 "it was too much death to contemplate, too much savagery and suffering"
- Total of 65 million deaths worldwide

The Holocaust (1933-1945)

Introduction

- definition: the systematic, state-sponsored persecution and murder of 6 million European Jews by the Nazi German regime and its allies and collaborators
- began in 1933 when Hitler came to power and ended in 1945 when allies defeated axis

- aka. 'The Shoah' - means catastrophe

Target: Jews

- **antisemitism: prejudice against or hatred of Jewish people; this was an old, widespread form of prejudice throughout history that date back to the Middle Ages (500-1400)**
- Middle Ages Christians blamed Jews for the death of Jesus
- Nazis accused Jews for Germany's defeat in WW1 (1914-1918)
- Nazis saw Jews as a separate and inferior and dangerous race
- Nazis since WW1 aimed for a pure Aryan race
- **Jews: Nazis defined them as people identified as Christians or anyone who didn't practice Judaism**

Practices of the Holocaust

- During WW2 when Germany annexed so much of Europe and USSR, Nazi influence resulted in religious/ethnic persecution and execution across Europe
- Generally, Nazi Germany persecuted (hostility and ill-treatment on the basis of beliefs, ethnicity) Jews
- regulations/practices of persecution:
 - **1935 Nuremberg race laws - outlawed Jewish-German marriages; loss of citizenship**
 - antisemitic propaganda, boycotts (protest) of Jewish owned business, public humiliation by putting badges on Jews for identification
 - VIOLENCE: ex. **Kristallnacht - concerted violence by Nazis throughout Germany and Austria to Jews**
- Ghettos, deportation, isolation
- Internment (imprisoning people)
- confiscation of Jewish property
- forced labor
- prohibiting sexual relations between Jews and 'German blooded people'
- Hitler was the main leader; along with other Nazi leaders like Hermann Göring, Heinrich Himmler, Reinhard Heydrich, and Adolf Eichmann; other Axis powers, local institutions and bureaucracies

The 'Final Solution to the Jewish Question'

- January 1942: Finalized in the Wannsee Conference
- definition: the deliberate and systematic mass murder of Jews
- last stage of the Holocaust that took place 1941-1945
- liquidation: process of dissolving ghetto administrative structures
- their approach:
 - 1) MASS SHOOTING
 - on outskirts of villages, towns, cities
 - unprecedented scale
 - no shame - massacres were conducted in daylight in front of residents
 - German units that did this included Einsatzgruppen (special task forces of the SS and police), Order Police battalions, Waffen-SS units

- German military provided logistical support

2) GAS POISONING

- at killing centers with mobile gas vans which included carbon monoxide exhausting
- took the name of 'euthanasia' or 'mercy death' where Nazis disguised that they were gonna mass murder the jews, they said they were going to provide them with showers instead

Killing Centers

- late 1941, Nazis built killing centers in German-occupied Poland
- aka. 'extermination camps' or 'death camps'
- **operated 5 killing centers: Chelmno, Belzec, Sobibor, Treblinka, Auschwitz- Birkenau**
- murdered jews by using poisonous gas
- Nazis disguised their intentions when deporting jews to killing centers by calling the deportations 'resettlement actions'
- inhumane living conditions
- some jews who were stronger were sent to forced labor

Ghettos

- definition: areas of cities or towns where German occupiers forced Jews to live in overcrowded and unsanitary conditions
- enclosed by building walls; guards made sure jews don't escape
- purpose: holding sites prior to deportation or murder
- first ghettos created in German Occupied Poland; in Warsaw and Lodz
- original purpose: to isolate and control large local jewish populations in occupied eastern Europe
- exploitation of jews: forced labor in factories and workshops
- minimal food and extreme temperatures and physical torture/attacked by Nazis
- Jews in ghettos maintained a sense of dignity and community; they practiced spiritual and physical uprisings/resistances:
 - spiritual: shabbat archive
 - armed resistance: warsaw ghetto uprising in 1943

Who helped out with the Holocaust

- organizations: Nazi Party, SA (stormtroopers), SS (Schutzstaffel, Protection Squadron)
- German military, national railway and healthcare systems, German civil service and crime justice systems and companies and banks all helped out with 'the final solution'
- some Germans cheered as jews were beaten; Germans took their jewish neighbor's properties
- other axis powers and Vichy France
- German backed local bureaucracies - local police forces - deport Jews
- some citizens/individuals denounced jews to German authorities and exposed their hiding places; they then took their valuables
- motives for German citizens: enthusiasm, fear, self-interest

- most individuals were just BYSTANDERS though
- Many individuals decided to help out Hitler since Nazi propaganda reinforced longstanding, local antisemitic prejudices
- 'jew hunters'- some because they ideologically aligned with the Nazis, and some due to the incentive of receiving monetary rewards

Other victims of the holocaust

- Nazis targeted other groups as threats to health, unity, and security of German people
- 1) Political opponents - officials and members of other political parties and even those who were suspected of opposing the Nazi regime; they were sent to concentration camps or arrested if they refused to serve in the military
- 2) Germans who practiced 'dangerous activities' - men accused of homosexuality, asocials (beggars, prostitutes, alcoholics) - also sent to concentration camps
- 3) Black people
- 4) People with disabilities
- 5) minorities like Roma(Gypsies), Poles(polish people), Soviet prisoners of war
- 6) Communists, Socialists, Jehovah's witnesses

End of the Holocaust

- when WW2 ended, after the strategic and systematic bombing of Hitler's occupied territories, he lost power and then suicided
- USSR and Americans liberated surviving prisoners and survivors of death marches
- but prejudice against jews continued, some survivors though physically alive, but faced ongoing threats of antisemitism and displacement in their new lives

Survivors of the Holocaust

- most Jews that survived within Germany was due to help from others (both jewish and non-jewish) - people found hiding spots for them and procured false papers that protected their Christian identities, provided them with food/supplies
- LUCK
- most survivors: jews that emigrated from Germany once they saw signs of destruction, they escaped to US, Britain; this was very difficult to do because no country wanted them (antisemitism evolved over the borders of Germany)

Brutal Consequences

- Survivors confronted trauma of having their entire family lost
- some had PTSD from war
- some were isolated
- deportations still lightly occurred in Hungary
- in conclusion, the Nazi Germany and its allies and collaborators had completely devastated thousands of Jewish communities across Europe

The Cold War (1945-1991)

Introduction

- definition: a period of geopolitical tension between the US and the USSR and their respective allies, the Western Bloc and the Eastern Bloc
- a period of intense rivalry between two global superpowers: the US and the USSR
- lasted from end of WW2 in 1945 until the collapse of the USSR in 1991
- ideological war: US (capitalism, democracy, and individual freedoms) vs. USSR (communism, state controlled economy, one party rule)
- did not involve a direct military conflict - why it's called a Cold War
- this never evolved into a hot war (active fighting) because WW2 just ended where both sides have not recovered from that; and both sides have nuclear weapons but no side will use them due to **Mutually Assured Destruction (MAD)**
- two powers competed for influence in Europe, Asia, Africa and Latin America
- both sides built massive military forces and developed nuclear weapons that threatened global destruction

The Yalta Conference (Feb 1945)

- purpose: agree on a post-war settlement and decide what to do with Germany
- important figures: Prime minister Winston Churchill (Britain), President FDR (US), Premier Joseph Stalin (USSR)
- outcomes:
 - 1) **Postdam excerpt**: Germany would be divided into 4 zones of occupation with **USSR, Britain, US, and France** each controlling one of the zones; France was included because Churchill and FDR forced a role given to it
 - Germany Split-Up: Northwest - UK, Northeast - USSR, Southeast - US, Southwest - France
 - 2) Berlin be divided into 4 zones of occupation with  same countries
 - 3) Countries freed from Nazi control can hold free, democratic elections to choose their own governments
 - known as the DECLARATION ON LIBERATED EUROPE
 - Stalin was offered a sphere of influence in Eastern Europe where communist ideals would dominate
- All the leaders made a commitment to pursue and put on trial suspected Nazi war criminals
- prevent Nazis from doing further harm
- 4) The Allies agreement of setting up the **United Nations (UN) - organization dedicated to international cooperation and the prevention of war**

Konrad Adenauer's memoir (first prime minister of west Germany)

- Potsdam conference said to treat Germany as a single economic unit but this failed
- powers agreed on required consensus by the Control Council (France, USSR, UK, US) for

every decision but this also failed - they refused to listen to each other
- four occupation zones drew further economically apart, hindering economic stability
especially after WW2
since each occupied zone decided to pursue it's own policy